📖 Reading a Recipe: Reading

Culinary 1 · Unit 11 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Recipes Used in Class (her lab recipes, collected)

Name: _____

How to Read a Recipe

Every lab in Culinary 1 starts with a recipe. A recipe has a title, the yield (how many servings it makes), a list of ingredients with amounts, the equipment you need, and the directions in order. Some also list the oven temperature and the cooking time.

Read the whole recipe before you start. Then do mise en place: set out every tool and ingredient. This is how you catch problems early, like needing butter softened or the oven preheated.

Recipes use short forms. tsp means teaspoon, Tbsp means tablespoon, c means cup, oz means ounce, lb means pound and °F means degrees Fahrenheit. A small t is a teaspoon and a big T is a tablespoon, so read carefully.

Cooking words tell you what to do: preheat (heat the oven first), combine (mix together), fold (gently mix in), simmer (cook just below a boil), sauté (cook quickly in a little fat) and garnish (decorate the plate).

To make more or less, change every amount the same way. To double a recipe, multiply each amount by 2. To make half, divide each amount by 2. Our class recipe book has our lab recipes, like chocolate chip cookies, scones, soft pretzels, vegetable stir-fry, pico de gallo, cream of anything soup and German pancakes.

Check your reading

1. What are the parts of a recipe?

2. What does yield mean?

3. A recipe needs ¾ cup sugar. How much for a double batch?